



fellows fellowssc <fellows@science-corps.org>

New Science Corps Fellow Application: Tanvi Chheda

1 message

Science Corps Web <eduversumdev@gmail.com>
To: fellows@science-corps.org

Sun, May 24, 2020 at 2:46 PM

Name

Tanvi Chheda

Gender

Female

Nationality

India

Emailtanvic@stanford.edu**When did or will you finish your PhD?**

December 2020

City, state, and country of residence

Stanford, CA, USA

University education

PhD | Geology | Stanford University | 2016-20

BS | Science of Earth Systems | Cornell University | 2012-16

What are your reasons for applying to be a Science Corps Fellow? (max. 200 words)

I grew up in a family with little resources, and education changed my life and took me places. I want to inspire enthusiasm for sciences in others, like my teachers did for me. The Science Corps term would be a great opportunity for me to contribute to global science education, while also improving my science communication skills for future such endeavors.

Having worked in Europe, North America, and Africa, and always assimilated well, I'm excited to immerse in South East Asian culture. Some aspects I would love to incorporate in my teaching, that weren't really taught in my primary education, are the scientific method's application in daily life, critical thinking, and fact checking. I think this learning will carry far in

student's lives when dealing with misinformation, decisions about health, etc. My undergraduate professors not only introduced me to the intricately beautiful world of rocks, but also encouraged me to apply for a PhD program. I was motivated, but lacked the confidence to think that I had any chance of being accepted. The encouragement was pivotal, and I want to help and guide other students in a similarly enthusiastic and positive way.

In addition to your studies, describe any relevant experiences that have prepared you for a Science Corps fellowship (max. 200 words)

I have TA'd undergraduate and graduate courses, and designed labs, given lectures, and held office hours. I've held leadership positions in student organizations, and also been a communicator between different teams in a company. Being among the first in my neighborhood and community to get a scholarship to study abroad, I'm invited to speak at higher education seminars and workshops when I return to India. I have spoken to over 500 students and their parents at such events. Of these, I have stayed in touch with seven students as a long term mentor, guiding them through their ups and downs in high school and college.

I have also been a judge for two years for a science competition that brings 1300 middle and high school students from Santa Clara county. I haven't taught students that age, but hope I get a chance to do so through Science Corps. I think empathy and relating to people of any age and culture are things I've imbibed from wonderful people I've met along the way, but experiences like TA-ing have also taught me more procedural aspects like course design, working with fellow educators, and iterating to better things along the course.

Where do you imagine yourself professionally in the future? Check all that apply.

Doing science in industry
Administrative role in industry or academia
In science outreach

Expand on your selection above and describe where you imagine yourself professionally in the near (2 year) and long-term (10 year) future (max. 200 words)

I have jobs offer from two oil companies, but am going to apply for options that more closely align with my moral compass. I plan to interview with tech companies in the Bay Area, and am especially looking at positions with science as well as people aspects, in companies like Verily Life Sciences. I think that if I end up feeling passionate about teaching after the Science Corps term, I will consider it as a long term option, perhaps more joyful than academia or industry.

CV/Resumé

[Tanvi-2020-Q1-resume.pdf](#)

How did you find out about Science Corps?

Institutional newsletter

Any extra comment or message.

I'd also be excited to teach computationally focused course: programming basics or applications. Thank you for your time and consideration!

